

THE ARTIST SERIES OPPORTUNITY

A CONSUMER PRODUCTS AND LICENSING CASE FOR PFL AND MVP

The merger announced on 30 July 2026 puts boxing and MMA under one banner, behind an MMA debut that drew **12.4 million viewers on Netflix** in May. The licensing infrastructure to convert that attention is already in place, with CAA Sports Licensing appointed as exclusive trademark representative and Takedown supplying performance and lifestyle apparel. What sits between the audience and the shelf is a design system: the graphic language, style guide and seasonal creative that turn a fight night into a product drop.

12.4M

Viewers for MVP's MMA debut on Netflix, May 2026

300+

Fighters on the PFL roster, drawn from over 40 countries

\$4.63BN

MMA merchandise, equipment and nutrition market in 2026, growing at 6% a year

01 THE PRECEDENT

UFC ARTIST SERIES

The UFC commissions original artwork for its marquee cards and releases it as limited edition Artist Series prints, tees and collectibles, extending the model into designer art toys with Stancé and illustrator Tracy Tubera. Each event becomes a dated, collectable drop rather than a restock of the primary logo, and the artwork carries the fighters fans came for.

TKO's own numbers carry the commercial read. Consumer products licensing grew across the portfolio through 2025, with WWE's reaching **\$136.4 million, up 23 per cent year on year**, and UFC's rising on merchandise and gaming. Artwork led programmes monetise the roster and marks a promotion already owns.

02 THE ADJACENT FIELD

FIGHT IP IN LIFESTYLE

ONE Championship has run an athleisure business since 2018 and built it on outside creative credibility: a camouflage capsule by SBTG, whose client list runs to Nike, Arsenal and Paris Saint-Germain, and a no-gi collaboration with Shoyoroll. Combat sports IP now sits alongside the brands fans wear outside the arena, and ONE reached that position on a fraction of the audience the merged business commands.

03 THE STUDIO

PROVEN IN SPORT AND COMBAT

Studio IOS builds the design systems that carry sports IP into lifestyle. For Fuji we delivered the brand guide and style guide governing how the brand is drawn and extended, including fighter led artwork grounded in research, such as the Rickson Gracie graphic built from his own fight material. For ESPN we translated broadcast storytelling into a fashion first style guide, reframing a sports broadcaster as a lifestyle brand embedded in the everyday culture of sport.

The same work runs through Chelsea, Ferrari, LA28 and the FIA World Endurance Championship, alongside seasonal trend reporting for Scramble and Phalanx. Combat sports fluency and premium licensing discipline in one studio.

PROPOSED ROUTE

STAGE 01

BRAND AND STYLE GUIDE

One graphic language for the merged business, covering fight kit, fan apparel and the licensee packs CAA already distributes. Vector built for easy re-colouring and territory rollout.

STAGE 02

ARTIST SERIES PILOT

Commissioned fighter artwork around one marquee card, released as a limited drop of prints, tees and collectibles. A contained test with a clear read on sell-through.

STAGE 03

SEASONAL LIFESTYLE COLLECTION

Trend forecast through to product, two drops a year, built to scale across licensees and territories and to hold shelf space next to streetwear.

Every fight night already produces a poster. The opportunity is to make it something a fan wears home.